**COIMBATORE INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, COIMBATORE-641014**
**(Government Aided Autonomous Institution, Affiliated to Anna University, Chennai)**
**DEPARTMENT OF PLACEMENT CELL**

**ACADEMIC YEAR 2025-26**

**STUDENT FEEDBACK**

Student Name : Haribalakrishnan N

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Company name : De Shaw & Co

Company type : IT

Salary (ctc) : 59 LPA

Intern offered : Yes

Bond : No

***(Please comment this section in detail to guide your juniors in a bright way)***

**COMMENTS ON SELECTION PROCESS:**

**ROUND 1**

**Platform Used:** HackerRank
**Round Details:**

- **Sections:**
  - **Coding Problems:**
    - Problem 1: 20 minutes
    - Problem 2: 30 minutes
  - **Technical MCQs:** 20 minutes
  - **Aptitude MCQs:** 20 minutes

- **Difficulty:** Medium to Hard for coding; MCQs were moderate
- **Topics Covered:**
  - Coding platforms: LeetCode, HackerRank, CodeChef
  - CS fundamentals: OS, DBMS, Networking

**Tips:**

- Focus mainly on the coding questions—they carry most of the weight.
- MCQs and aptitude are relatively easier, a solid understanding of college-level concepts is sufficient.

Did you clear this round? **Yes**

**Details about questions on 1st round:**

| DOMAIN | QUESTION | Your Approach / Solution | REFERENCES (If any) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Problem solving** | Given number of servers and clients, and minimum required servers/clients, find number of valid combinations | Applied combinatorics (NCr) considering constraints (n ≤ 1e5). | |
| **Problem solving** | Given an image, return the grey value as: sum of 1s in row and column – sum of 0s in row and column | Precomputed row/column sums and computed value per cell efficiently. | |

**ROUND 2 : Technical Interview**

Platform used: One to One

Round details:

- This round was a head to head technical round and this round featured a lot of questions from data structures to covering up all the core areas in os ,dbms ,system design and testing.
- The questions started with basic structure and it will move till the best optimized solution

Topics/Areas Covered:

- Math
- Problem Solving
- DBMS,OS.

- System Design

Your Comments:

It is a head to head round so they will give a problem and I will solve it and it will move till the best optimized solution. Like as far as my understanding , they look at your intuition like how you approach the given problem. If you give a solution try to prove it or if the solution is wrong try to disprove it. Understand the question clearly and ask for doubts and just provide a approach and try to prove it.

Did you clear this round? **Yes**

**Details about Questions on 2nd round:**

| DOMAIN | QUESTION | Your Approach / Solution | REFERENCES (If any) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Problem solving** | Find the Lowest Common Ancestor (LCA) and support queries for LCA | My approach for the LCA was a straight forward dfs. For the queries part I provided a solution using Binary Lifting. | cp-algorithms LCA |
| **Problem Solving** | Find subarray with maximum GCD, allowing doubling of elements at most k times | Since $n \leq 1500$, used $O(n^2)$ approach. Tried all subarrays and improved GCD by selectively doubling elements. | Leetcode: 3574 |

**Areas to prepare :**

- **General problem solving**
- **Combinatorics**
- **DBMS, OOPS, OS**

**Sites / books you suggest for preparation for the process :**

- Sites: Leetcode , codechef , cses problemset.
- Book: competitive programmers handbook (cses)

**Overall experience :**

The overall experience was great, like they will start with simple problems and questions and it goes till an optimal solution is provided. They will look for your intuition and approach. The questions are not standard or kind of like that they change based on your answer.

**General tips:**

- Trust your intuition and take time to clarify questions.
- Only answer when confident and always try to prove or justify your solution.
- If you realize an error, don't hesitate to correct your approach mid-way.

**ROUND 3 : Technical Interview**

Round 3 was also a technical head on head interview same as Round 2 ,but with a different panel.